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THE SECRETARY

October 18, 1954

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MEMORANDUM OF CONFERENCE WITH THE PRESIDENT, THE WHITE HOUSE, 8:00 to 9:00 A.M.

1. I thanked the President for having given me an alibi for the Pakistani dinner.

2. I disucssed the matter of a security treaty with Nationalist China to cover Formosa and the Pescadores coupled with UN action to deal with the offshore islands under National control such as Quemoy. The President agreed that we should follow this procedure. He said that as far as he was concerned, the United States would never tolerate Formosa and the Pescadores going into unfriendly hands. He also reaffirmed the point I had mentioned, namely, that Formosa and the Pescadores had a distinctive juridical status under the Japanese Peace Treaty. They were not technically under Chinese sovereignty since Japan had made no cession in favor of China. The President agreed, however, that once we made a security treaty with Nationalist China covering Formosa and the Pescadores, it would be necessary for them to refrain from offensive operations from their "privileged sanctuary".

I expressed the view that we ought to explore this situation as rapidly as possible with Senate leaders. I stated that we had already done so with Senator Knowland, who was in accord. I felt we should also cover Senator Wiley and Senator Smith, the latter of whom I knew favored such a treaty. On the Democratic side, there was Johnson, George, Sparkman and Mansfield. The President agreed that we should try to have contact with them as rapidly as possible.

I said that I doubted that the UK would proceed in the Security Council before I had had a talk with Eden in Paris, and I felt that it would be important for me to tell Eden the line upon which we were thinking. The President concurred.

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3. I said that one of the matters that would come up in Paris would be possible agreement of the United States to channel its military aid to the Brussels Treaty powers through the Brussels Treaty Council. I recalled that we had agreed that military aid to EDC countries would be given through EDC, but I pointed out that that was the case when the EDC was a supra-national organization through which national armies were abolished. Therefore, EDC was the only logical recipient since national governments did not have any more national armies in Europe. Now it was different because there were national armies. The President felt that it would be impractical and unwise to make any agreement that while the United States would provide the military aid, the Brussels Treaty powers would dispense it. In general, he agreed that we should follow the NATO force goals and SACEUR advice with reference to dispensing our aid, but that we could not abdicate wholly in favor of the Brussels Council. He suggested that I should discuss this problem with Gruenther and thought we could probably arrive at some statement of policy which would satisfy the legitimate desires of the Brussels Treaty powers to build up the Brussels Council.

4. I spoke of the desire of the French that the United States, possibly with the United Kingdom, should "guarantee" a Saar settlement. The President felt that it was wholly out of the question to make any treaty of guaranty. He said that the Saar was too small and too unknown to warrant treaty action. He felt that so far as any forcible change was concerned, that could be dealt with within the general context of our European understandings, and that while we could state what our policy might be at an eventual peace conference, we could not make any legally binding commitments. Recognizing the fact that the Saar might be the most critical point in the present state of negotiations, the President agreed that we should do whatever was practical and reasonable, but within the limits he had outlined.

5. I said that I had worked very hard on a possible statement to be made defining our Near East policies in relation to Israel and the Arabs. I had come to the conclusion that it would be unwise to make any statement at the present time because it

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would inevitably have political overtones. I was reinforced in this view by Adlai Stevenson's speech which had injected the issue in a politically partisan address. The President fully shares the view that I should not make any statement, recognizing that it would be looked upon as being a capitulation to Jewish pressures. He said that he might mention the subject very generally in language I might suggest in his New York speech next Wednesday.

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6. I referred to the fact that there were a number of diplomatic appointments which I was holding in suspense until I saw the result of the elections as some new candidates might emerge. I mentioned one or two changes which I thought desirable. The President raised the question as to whether Cooper was sufficiently flexible to be a good diplomat.

7. The President suggested that I might avail of a press conference to meet some of the charges of the lack of bipartisan policy. I expressed some doubt as to the wisdom of this but said that I would give it reconsideration in the light of the President's suggestion.

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